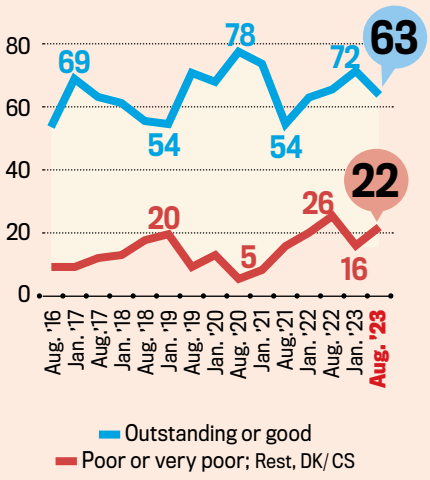
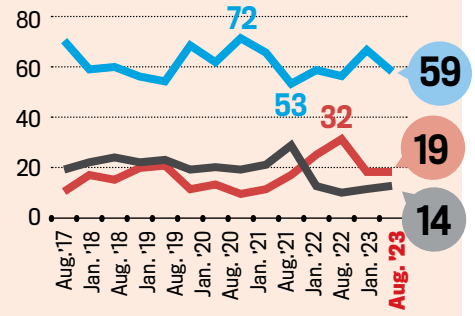
MODI'S PERFORMANCE ACROSS MOTNs



Outstanding or good
Poor or very poor; Rest, DK/ CS

Despite the slight drop, Modi's popularity remains unassailable

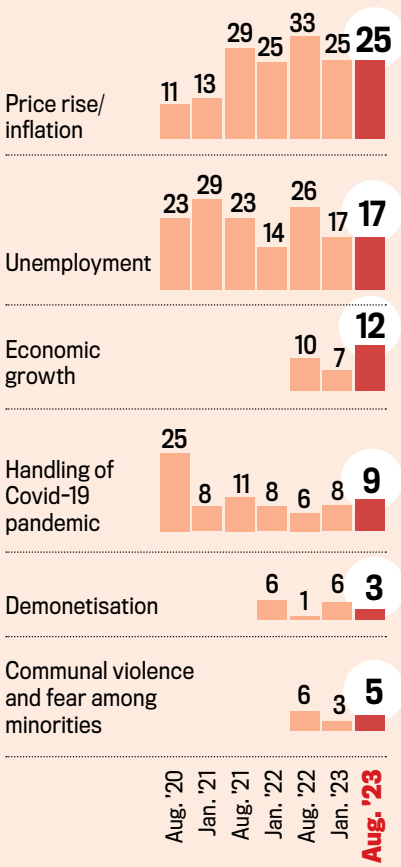
Q. How satisfied are you with the overall performance of the NDA government?



Very satisfied or satisfied
Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied
Unsatisfied or very unsatisfied; Rest, DK/ CS

Though still high, the feelgood factor has paled a bit

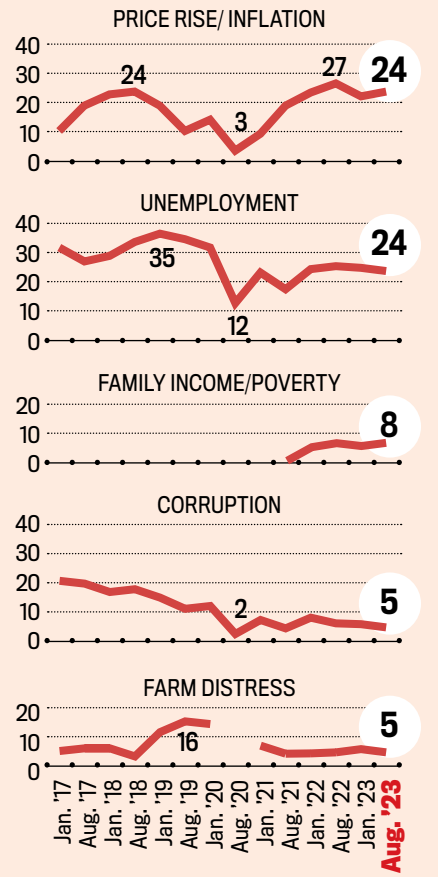
Q. What would you consider as the biggest failure of the NDA government?



Rest: Others & DK/ CS

Price rise and jobs have been a constant blot on the government record

Q. What do you think is the biggest problem facing India currently?



Inflation and unemployment continue to dominate the citizens' concerns

29%

AGED BETWEEN 25 AND 34, HIGHEST ACROSS ALL AGE GROUPS, TERM PRICE RISE AS NDA GOVT'S BIGGEST FAILURE

Despite INDIA's vote percentage of 41 per cent—just 1.6 percentage points below the NDA's—the spread of its votes pushes its tally considerably below that of the ruling alliance. However, there is also a warning for the NDA: the tipping margins of votes could pose a challenge once the election campaign enters the last mile.

What could be of comfort to the BJP is that the party has steadily recovered ground even as its allies have deserted it. In the August 2021 MOTN poll, its tally had dropped to 269 seats, precariously short of a majority. This was mostly due to the loss of lives and livelihood during the Covid-19 pandemic. The BJP has rebuilt its numerical strength since, and its current figure of 287 is four seats higher than the number in January 2023. This upward turn can only be a good sign for the ruling party, indicating a reversal of anti-incumbency trends. In contrast, when the UPA had entered its 10th year in 2013, the MOTN numbers in August that year showed a plunge from 259 seats to 137 and a rise in BJP fortunes. The UPA's disastrous run continued in the January 2014 poll with 103 seats. When the results of the actual election were announced four months later, the verdict was even direr—just 59 seats, a vertical fall from the 262 in 2009. The Congress tally had dropped to its worst since Independence—to 44 from 206 in 2009.

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: don't know/ can't say